

3.5 Assessment criteria for Speaking

Task A (picture-based discussion)

Mark	Communication and content (AO4)
0	No rewardable material.
1–2	• Responds briefly to questions, some responses may consist of single-word answers, much hesitation and continuous prompting needed. • Limited success in adapting language to describe, narrate, inform in response to questions; sometimes unable to respond. • Straightforward opinions may be expressed but generally without justification. • Pronunciation and intonation are inconsistently intelligible, with inaccuracies that lead to some impairment in communication.
3–4	• Responds to questions with some development, some hesitation and some prompting necessary. • Some effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to questions. • Expresses opinions with occasional, brief justification. • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, occasionally inaccuracies affect clarity of communication.
5–6	• Responds to questions with frequently developed responses, only occasional hesitation and only occasional prompting necessary. • Frequently effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to questions. • Expresses opinions effectively and gives justification, with some development. • Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies are minimal and have no impact on clarity of communication.
7–8	• Responds to questions with consistently fluent and developed responses. • Consistently effective adaptation of language to describe, narrate and inform in response to questions. • Expresses opinions with ease and gives fully-developed justification. • Pronunciation and intonation are consistently accurate and intelligible.

Mark	Linguistic knowledge and accuracy (A04)
0	No rewardable language.
1	- Occasional accuracy in grammatical structures in response to questions; occasional success when referring to past, present and/or future events. - Occasional coherent phrases and short sentences in response to questions; regular instances of error that sometimes prevent meaning being conveyed.
2	- Some accurate grammatical structures, including some successful references to past, present and/or future events in response to questions, some ambiguity. - Responses are partially coherent, errors occur that sometimes hinder clarity of communication and occasionally prevent meaning being conveyed.
3	- Generally accurate grammatical structures, generally successful references to past, present and/or future events in response to questions, occasional ambiguity. - Responses are generally coherent although errors occur that occasionally hinder clarity of communication.
4	- Consistently accurate grammatical structures, successful references to past, present and/or future events in response to questions. - Responses are fully coherent and any errors do not hinder the clarity of communication.

Tasks B and C (conversations)

Mark	Communication and content (AO4)
0	No rewardable material.
1–3	- Communicates brief information relevant to the topics and questions. - Uses language to express straightforward ideas and opinions but generally without justification. - Repetitive use of familiar vocabulary and expression, communication is disjointed and sometimes breaks down because of restricted range of vocabulary. - Pronunciation and intonation are inconsistently intelligible, with inaccuracies that lead to some impairment in communication.
4–6	- Communicates information relevant to the topics and questions, with occasionally extended sequences of speech. - Uses language to produce straightforward ideas, thoughts and opinions, with occasional justification. - Uses a limited variety of mainly straightforward vocabulary, communication for some purposes is constrained because of restricted range of vocabulary. - Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies occasionally affect clarity of communication.
7–9	- Communicates information relevant to the topics and questions, usually with extended sequences of speech. - Frequently uses language creatively to express and justify some individual thoughts, ideas and opinions. - Uses a variety of vocabulary, including some examples of uncommon language, with some variation of expression that fulfils most purposes. - Pronunciation and intonation are intelligible, inaccuracies are minimal and have no impact on clarity of communication.
10–12	- Communicates detailed information relevant to the topics and questions, consistently extended sequences of speech. - Consistently uses language creatively to express and justify a wide variety of individual thoughts, ideas and opinions. - Consistently uses a wide variety of vocabulary, including uncommon language, to consistently vary expression for different purposes. - Pronunciation and intonation are consistently accurate and intelligible.

Mark	Interaction and spontaneity (AO4)
0	No rewardable material.
1–2	• Basic exchange in which answers rely on rehearsed language that is occasionally irrelevant to the question. • Short responses, some incomplete, any development depends on examiner prompting. • Limited ability to sustain communication, pace is mostly slow and hesitant.
3–4	• Able to respond spontaneously to some questions with some examples of natural interaction although often stilted. • Sometimes able to initiate and develop responses independently but regular prompting needed. • Sometimes able to sustain communication, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow; frequent hesitation.
5–6	• Responds spontaneously to most questions, interacting naturally for parts of the conversation. • Mostly able to initiate and develop the conversation independently, occasional prompting needed. • Able to sustain communication throughout most of the conversation, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow; occasional hesitation.
7–8	• Responds spontaneously and with ease to questions, resulting in natural interaction. • Consistently able to initiate and develop the conversation independently. • Able to sustain communication throughout, using rephrasing/repair strategies if necessary to continue the flow.

Mark	Linguistic knowledge and accuracy (A04)
0	No rewardable language.
1–2	• Repetitive use of straightforward words, phrases and grammatical structures; limited evidence of language manipulation. • Occasionally accurate use of structures, occasional success when referring to past, present and future events, much ambiguity. • Occasional coherent phrases and short sentences; regular instance of errors that sometimes prevent meaning being conveyed.
3–4	• Manipulates a variety of mainly straightforward grammatical structures, minimal use of complex structures. • Some accurate grammatical structures, some successful references to past, present and future events, some ambiguity. • Sequences of coherent speech although errors occur that hinder clarity of communication and sometimes prevent meaning being conveyed.
5–6	• Manipulates grammatical structures with occasional variation, complex structures used but repetitive. • Generally accurate grammatical structures, generally successful references to past, present and future events. • Generally coherent speech although errors occur that occasionally hinder clarity of communication.
7–8	• Manipulates a wide variety of grammatical structures, frequent use of complex structures. • Consistently accurate grammatical structures, consistently successful references to past, present and future events. • Fully coherent speech; any errors do not hinder the clarity of communication.